



Azerbaijan: The Hidden Gem waiting to be discovered by Indian Travellers

Azerbaijan, the 'Land of Fire,' is a captivating country at the crossroads of Europe and Asia. As part of the ancient Silk Route, it blends cultures seamlessly, offering travellers architectural marvels and rich traditions.

Start in **Baku,** where futuristic Flame Towers and historic sites like Icherisheher's Maiden Tower and Palace of the Shirvanshahs coexist. Enjoy views from Seaside Boulevard and Highland Park, and stroll along Baku Boulevard for charming tea houses, souvenir shops, and Azerbaijani cuisine. The Carpet Museum and Heydar Aliyev Center showcase the nation's rich heritage and modern spirit.

A short drive from **Baku, Gobustan National Park** features ancient petroglyphs and mud-volcanoes, offering a time capsule of human history.

In the Greater Caucasus foothills, **Sheki** boasts old-world charm. Visit Sheki Khan's Palace with its stained-glass windows and frescoes, and explore caravanserais and vibrant markets.

Head north to Guba and **Gusar** for stunning peaks, traditional villages, and the Shahdag Mountain Resort for skiing and winter sports. These regions offer excellent hiking and ecotourism opportunities.

Gabala's lush forests, lakes, and mountains make it a paradise for adventure enthusiasts. Activities include hiking, skiing, and zip-lining. The Tufandag Mountain Resort offers winter sports, and Nohur Lake provides a tranquil retreat.

In Azerbaijani experience is incomplete without food. Savour plov, dolma, kebabs, pakhlava, and shekerbura, and enjoy Azerbaijani tea with jams. Try the unique pomegranate wine.

Azerbaijan Airlines operates direct flights from Delhi and Mumbai to Baku. Indigo, Flydubai, and other airlines offer convenient routes. Indian travellers can easily secure a visa online for $25.



